

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-qvsk-ymg
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001
Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-2927
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: E J Werth

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

Letter to WH about AI

To Whom It May Concern at the Federal Register, regarding The White House's Executive Order issued on February 25th, 2025 titled "Public Comment Invited on Artificial Intelligence Action Plan":

As a full stack software engineer with 15 years professional experience in the corporate world, I have broad technical experience to meaningfully add to this conversation. For context, I work on multiple applications with large datasets that transfer, submit, and manage data between financial institutions. My job involves risk analysis and implementation of structures that handle large clusters of data, including PHI.

AI – including LLM's and procedural AI – undeniably pose the possibility of exponential boons in productivity and advancements in risk analysis and pattern recognition. It also comes with many risks, especially with the rate it is changing. The biggest public deterrent with what has become colloquially termed as "AI" in the tech world is the unhindered training of LLM's using harvested data. Much of the public do not know how their data is being used and have no control over it after it is transferred or uploaded. There is data that users uploaded decades ago – before "modern AI" became what it is – that is now being used by some companies to train models without the explicit permission of users who uploaded that data (such as social media companies). This has created an inherent (and understandable) distrust of AI, and has resulted in legal challenges to how data is used. This comes with a high cost – both in trust of entities using data and financially.

I understand the necessity to be at the forefront of technology for defensive purposes. There are large datasets of information that the US has harvested across various government entities – known and unknown to the public. With data breaches being as common as they are it is critical we protect that data from private parties – including US companies. No company is perfect – frequently private institutions are very imperfect in ways for one purpose – saving money. It is vital that we protect the ability of US citizens to operate without government intervention into their daily lives. We must protect data that US citizens have uploaded into or transferred across government servers.

Loaning our citizens' data to private entities comes with inherently high risk. AI models are in still their infancy (perhaps toddlers is a better term). There is only growth from here – at an exponential pace. It is important that we pass meaningful legislation now so that we set rules in place to prevent private interests and bad actors from monopolizing and selling US citizens data, especially to other bad actors. I fear that with data breaches being common across the tech world, using private companies to move forward on AI would holds much too high a risk. We should be protecting our citizens data from data harvesters and private entities – including public or private US companies.

Therefore, it is my personal and professional opinion that the US Government should act in the best interest of its citizens in the following ways:

- Under no circumstances should any branch of the government, contractor of the government, or government approved entity (3rd party or otherwise) use, sell, or lend data of US Citizens for any purpose of training AI models. This includes PHI data (SSN's, collected credit card info from payment systems, addresses, phone numbers, emails, demographics, location data, etc).
- Under no circumstances should any data uploaded to, transmitted by, or stored on a server controlled or operated by or at the behest of a US Government agency be used for any purposes to train AI models. This includes data uploaded to the Library of Congress – such as copy-written songs, writings, recordings, videos, etc.

I feel the need to specifically note the budgetary “slashing with a chainsaw” happening across the federal government. In my professional opinion I cannot under any circumstances recommend the executive branch implement an AI Action Plan at this current juncture. The risk is just too high.

Thank you for your time.

Sincerely,

Thomas “EJ” Werth